

It's the twitosphere, 140 characters at a time. Twitter has its types. The Compulsives like Shashi Tharoor and Gul Panag who don't believe in such a thing as too much information. The Narcissists like Mallika Sherawat who tweets about meeting a series of minor international celebrities, Vivek Oberoi who receives "sweet nicknames" from unnamed "adorable girls" with great gusto, and Rakhi Sawant who insists that she found *Veer* better than *3 Idiots*. The Tweethearts like Salman Khan and Priyanka Chopra who keep it simple, sometimes too much so. The Righteous like Shekhar Kapur, who throw existential questions in the middle of the night and then proceed to discuss them at great length. The Smartwits, like Shah Rukh Khan and Karan Johar, who tweet to market themselves. And yes the Jokesters like Sajid Khan who makes his followers crack up with mini-reviews ("Saw *Armored* last nite. Hmmm, not bad. Timepass. Though Laurence Fishburne (Morpheus from *Matrix*) has started looking like Mahendra Sandhu").

The best twits are the ones who just answer the simple question twitter throws everyone's way, what are you doing? For the queen of tweetaholics, Priyanka Chopra, twitter is immediate, throbbing with life, a connect to a whole new world and a way to enjoy the "uncensored interaction". It's also a "reality check" as she gets all types of tweets, from the "hugely loving and encouraging to the downright rude". For Imran Khan, too, it's a means to interact with fans although he says, "It can get a little stressful at times. By opening a twitter account you open yourself to a lot of negativity. Sometimes your tweets are used out of context by the media." For Gul

Panag, "It gives me an opportunity to voice my opinion and say what I want." Without a mediator (read journalist) in between? As sociologist Dharendra Kosambi from the Department of Sociology, Delhi University, says, twitter has great potential as it involves the user in a hassle-free manner, is simple to engage and extremely mobile. "In a few years, we as individuals will barely communicate through language with more than a handful of people," he says.

Twitter is the new facebook. Having an account is a must. Especially if there are fakes floating around, which prompted industrialist Vijay Mallya to announce himself as The Vijay Mallya, tweeting, "After seeing many imposters

I decided to register. Believe it or not, but I am The Vijay Mallya and I'm happy to tweet with you." Sociologist Sanjay Srivastava from the Institute of Economic Growth, Delhi University, calls it a powerful social tool which is helping democratisation, allowing people to connect

with each other on the go. Not just celebrities but ordinary people, or tweople, like Saad Akhtar, who runs the webcomic *Fly You Fools*, and has 4,198 followers for his smart alecky comments (Mandakini got 18 per cent ownership of RTGM-Raj Kapoor called it Wet Equity). Or Chetan R, who is a graphic designer by profession, but is also one of the most popular twits in twitterland with 65,229 followers. What does he tweet about? Well his preoccupation of the day and links that will lead you to fun stuff like 10 Most Outrageous Celebrity #Twitter Tantrums. Even fakeiplayer went from blog to twitter this year, with 1,912 followers.

Twitter has its uses, whether it was during the 26/11 attacks in Mumbai or the Iran Emergency, in getting information out when mainstream media fails. It also has its limits. Anyone using twitter

IT'S THE TWITTERVERSE, BANALITY'S LATEST ADDRESS. IT'S WHERE FELLOW TWITS ENGAGE IN WORD PLAY AND SOMETIMES SUFFER DEATH BY TWITTER.

Chetan Bhagat vs Bloggers

Some call it the fourth mistake of his life, while twits like @brainstuck, who writes, "My company is planning to install @chetan_bhagat as firewall", are getting kicks out of it. So what did Bhagat do? He tweeted against readers of pirated copies of his books and then kept blocking whoever poked fun at him.

Chetan Bhagat

"Almost anyone who is reading my pirated books can afford the original. It hurts me a lot personally. Just sharing."

Flyyoufools tweeted, "In a bad mood today, aren't we? Let me guess: Royalty check came in?"

An enraged Bhagat wrote, "Buddy, one more smart one and u r blocked. ok?"

